Speak out
3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 4 | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Put the words in brackets in the correct order to complete the sentences.

1 _____ (weeks / couple / we / of / A / ago, / were) in Istanbul for a conference.
2 We spend the summer in the mountains _____ (year / much / pretty / every).
3 We saw a group of people and they _____ (dancing / unusual / in / way / were / an).
4 I can't say your brother _____ (especially / seemed / interested) in the documentary.
5 _____ (realised / frustration, / my / I / To) I had mistakenly bought the wrong ticket.
6 _____ (result / As / of / spending / a) six months in Athens, his Greek improved considerably.
7 She had none of my details on file. _____ (that, / of / I / Because / had) to give her my details again.
8 _____ (as / how / it's / Seeing) so sunny today, why don't we do something outside?
9 _____ (the / Annoyed / way / by) we'd been treated, we decide to change internet provider.
10 _____ (fact / that / of / the / light / In) you don't have any experience, we'd like you to go on a training course.

/10

2 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 I'd love to go to the concert this weekend. **While** / **That said**, I don't know if I can afford it.
2 **Even though** / **Admittedly** she can't read music, she plays the guitar beautifully.
3 I've got an old phone you can borrow. **However** / **While**, the screen's a bit broken.
4 Interesting **that** / **though** the exhibition was, it was hard to get near the pictures because of the crowds.
5 Greedy **that** / **as** it may sound, I think I could eat another hot dog.
6 The library won't **open** / **have opened** yet. It's still too early.
7 We can't go out this weekend because I'll **be studying** / **study** for the exams.
8 Hopefully the problem will **have resolved** / **have been resolved** by next week. I'll let you know.
9 He could **have come** / **be coming** home from his overseas posting for the summer. We'll find out soon.
10 She'll have **worked** / **been working** all day so she'll be tired by the time she gets in.

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 We need to ___ out our message in simple terms so no one misunderstands it.
a signify **b** spell **c** specify
2 Let's see how the dictionary ___ this word.
a captures **b** conveys **c** defines
3 There has been a ___ in demand for energy-efficient cookers. Everyone wants them all of a sudden.
a catalyst **b** shift **c** surge
4 The new machinery has ___ the production process in the factory. It's so much faster now.
a remained **b** reverted **c** transformed
5 Unfortunately, life expectancy has been in ___ for several years as a result of increased poverty.
a decline **b** shift **c** switch

/5

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 This supermarket is for **vegans** / **vegetarians** so they don't sell any animal-related products.
2 If you're hungry, why don't you grab a **junk** / **snack**?
3 It's better to buy fruit that's **in season** / **out of season** because the quality and the price are better.
4 The guided tour aims to help people **reminisce** / **relive** the experience of life in Victorian London.
5 Seeing the children acting in the school play **brought** / **took** back memories of my own acting experience.

/5

5 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

fully automated	**greed**	**justice**	**scan**	**shuttle**
social unrest	**surveillance**	**tranquillity**		

1 The cause of the _____ seems to be unhappiness about the property taxes.
2 I love the peace and _____ that you get living in the countryside.
3 The reason some people are poor is because of the _____ of those who take more than they need.
4 The call centre is _____ now so it's impossible to speak to a person. You can only speak to a computer.
5 I have to _____ my finger in a machine in order to get into the gymnasium.

/5

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6 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for science and technology.

1 This device should **c** _ _ _ _ _ **t** the toxic gases into something safer.
2 We need to **e** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** more of our waste, by consuming less and recycling more.
3 It usually takes about three hours for my phone to **r** _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** completely.
4 This is a **s** _ _ _ **e-of-the-a** _ _ music player. It's the latest thing in sound entertainment.
5 You must be careful when you're handling **h** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **s** materials.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 I bought these boots back in the 1990s so I guess you could say they're ___ now.
a fancy **b** matching **c** vintage
2 It was a nice, tidy restaurant, but the food was rather ___. It just didn't have much flavour.
a classy **b** dull **c** fancy
3 There's no way I'm buying that hat. I wouldn't be ___ in it.
a seen dead **b** killing me **c** green with envy
4 I've looked for that book everywhere, but it's like trying to find ___ in a haystack.
a a fortune **b** a needle **c** nothing better
5 That coat looks ridiculous on me. It's about ___!
a hours to do it **b** a million times
c ten sizes too big
6 Why can't you share your cake with us? You're so ___!
a cost-effective **b** stingy **c** pricey
7 The ticket included a(n) ___ drink, which was good because I didn't have any money on me.
a complimentary **b** economical **c** discounted
8 ___ it, you should spend a little more time with your family.
a As I see **b** Frankly **c** It seems
9 Tourism is good for the local economy, but ___ of the coin is that the area is too crowded in summer.
a one side **b** one way **c** the other side
10 We ___ and I've agreed with a lot of what you've said.
a been great talking to you **b** 're all different
c seem to have quite similar ideas

/10

Total: /50

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Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT4.01] Listen to a speaker, Jasmine Patterson, talking about trends in education. Complete the sentences with a number, word or short phrase.

1 There are regular changes in _____ in education just as there are in the clothing and music industries.
2 The grammar school system is more interested in developing students in an _____ way.
3 Grammar schools first appeared in the _____, although they were not state-funded.
4 Students would go to secondary modern schools in order to _____.
5 Critics of the grammar school system thought it favoured a small group of _____ students.
6 SEL has helped students improve their academic achievement by approximately _____.
7 The views of educational experts like Montessori and Dewey were responsible for the _____ of SEL.
8 SEL has experienced a _____ despite not having been popular for some time.
9 PBL aims to provide learners with _____ to find solutions to the problems they might encounter in the real world.
10 PBL has never been as popular as other more teacher-centred approaches despite _____.

/10

2 [Audio PT4.02] Listen to a radio discussion about innovations in the year 2050. Match each statement with one of the innovations; human-like robots (HR), smart cities (SC) or a space elevator (SE). The innovations may be used more than once.

1 This concept is not likely to have been perfected by 2050. ___
2 We will be interacting with this innovation in our daily lives by 2050. ___
3 A previously used idea will have been modified to improve the urban environment. ___
4 This innovation will result in financial savings in the future. ___
5 Something resembling this innovation has appeared in the media recently. ___

/5

3 [Audio PT4.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Felicity recommends paying more attention to the stories we hear in the news. **T** / **F**
2 Felicity thinks a recent public performance by a robot was rather weak. **T** / **F**
3 Felicity explains how robots will be able to understand humans' feelings by studying their faces. **T** / **F**
4 According to Felicity, authorities will collect information on people in order to improve digital services. **T** / **F**
5 Felicity points out that the materials necessary for building a space elevator existed in the twentieth century. **T** / **F**

/5

READING

4 Read four extracts in which people talk about changing eating habits. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Raluca does not believe people have really changed their approach to cooking. **T** / **F**
2 Raluca thinks people are less inclined to cook at home because of a lack of available time. **T** / **F**
3 Gürhan thinks people struggle to afford the higher prices of ingredients at the moment. **T** / **F**
4 Gürhan points out that smaller independent restaurants have not seen increased numbers of customers. **T** / **F**
5 Uyen thinks the success of the Spanish diet is related to where products were purchased. **T** / **F**
6 Uyen highlights a tendency to revert to more traditional mealtime routines. **T** / **F**
7 Robert believes that criticism of the tendency to miss meals is justified. **T** / **F**

/7

A Raluca

While many people around the world continue to prepare their own food, there has been shift towards faster, more up-to-date ways of cooking. For instance, traditional ways of preparing dishes in India can involve hours of work, including preparing the raw ingredients and cooking dishes slowly on a low heat. For many people, nothing can beat the taste of home cooking. However, as the pace of life has grown faster, they're finding that they aren't able to dedicate enough time to the process. As a result, there has been a surge in sales of time-saving products intended for use in the domestic preparation of meals. Although this surge includes ready meals, consumers are more and more interested in healthy, home-made goods due to their deeper understanding of the need for a balanced diet. Such goods include pre-prepared rice and lentils, which can be used to speed up the preparation of traditional dishes.

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B Gürhan
Young people are not as hopeless in the kitchen as we tend to believe. Having been exposed to different types of cuisine from around the world, they are knowledgeable about ingredients and they have technical skills which put some members of the older generation to shame. They know exactly what vegetables are in season and the best way of preparing them. But while they're happy making their own pizza dough or miso soup, rising inflation means that getting the right ingredients is too pricey for many. While it looked like organic ingredients were becoming more accessible a few years ago, that is no longer the case. In fact, supermarket prices have shot up by nearly 15 percent in the last couple of years, while restaurant prices have risen less dramatically. As a result, some young people are less prone to buy food to cook at home as they find it more practical to eat out. That doesn't mean there's been a giant shift towards fine dining, but smaller independent restaurants are experiencing a surge in customers.

C Uyen
Of course, it depends on which part of the world you're from, but in many places you'll hear complaints about the decline in cookery skills among the younger generations. In Spain, for example, people reminiscing about their grandmother's cooking will insist that the younger generation are unable to match her skills in the kitchen or the choice of ingredients. Cooking for the family was a full-time job, which started with a trip to the market to source the freshest ingredients. They would form the basis of varied and nutritious meals, which helped to ensure that the Spanish diet was one of the healthiest in the world. Not only that, but mealtimes themselves were as regular as clockwork and everyone was expected to attend. There was no skipping meals in those days. Unfortunately, those days are long gone as younger people prefer to munch pre-packed sandwiches at their desks and microwave themselves ready meals in the evenings.

D Robert
Mealtimes vary a great deal, even within neighbouring countries. Nevertheless, what most countries have in common is a tradition of eating the same meals at the same time of day. In the past, when work schedules were less flexible, it made sense for everyone to stop working at the same time for lunch. Similarly, dinner would have coincided with the homecoming of the hungry workers. This type of eating habit was thought to be essential in maintaining a balanced diet. It's no surprise then that there has been some criticism of the more flexible attitudes to eating which we see today, such as skipping meals like breakfast. That said, there's evidence to suggest that, despite these changes, people's eating habits may actually have improved on those of the past. This is probably not the result of skipping meals, but of a better understanding of what foods contribute to a healthy diet, such as fewer fatty foods and more fruits and vegetables.

5 Read the extracts again. For questions 1–4, choose the correct speaker (A, B, C or D).

Which speaker …

1 does not agree with Raluca that there has been increased demand for food products to be consumed at home? ___
2 does not share Gürhan's view that people are now more competent cooks than they were in the past? ___
3 shares Uyen's view that people used to recognise the importance of eating regular times? ___
4 has the same view as Robert that nutritional standards have improved due to increased awareness? ___

/8

6 Read an extract from a story. Tick the topics (1–5) which are mentioned.

1 How the narrator feels in her dream. ___
2 How often the narrator goes to her local park. ___
3 What happens if you break the curfew. ___
4 Who persuaded the narrator to join The Resistance. ___
5 Why the narrator thinks the Metanet should be destroyed. ___

/5

Stepping out of the house and crossing the immaculate lawn, I get the sense something's not right. It all seems a bit too perfect. The gentle morning sunshine and the little fluffy clouds floating across the sky have a dream-like quality about them. Then, feeling something pulling at my wrist, I look down to see an elegant dog straining on its lead. Remembering now why I'd left the house, I stroll towards the park to take the dog for its morning walk. The neighbours smile and wave as we cross the street, but this is all far from natural. It takes me back to a film I saw years ago about a man stuck in a reality TV show. Every day he wakes up to a perfect 1950s suburban scene, bathed in peace and harmony. What was it called again?

Waking up, I bang my head on the wall behind me and curse to myself. For a moment there, I thought I was still in that quaint street, but I should have known it was a dream. When you're living in a nightmare, I guess you need some sort of escape. To be honest, it's been so long since we've been allowed out of the tower block, I'm not even sure parks and gardens exist anymore. Even if they did, you certainly wouldn't want to risk going out there. For one thing, anyone caught breaking the 24-hour curfew will be imprisoned indefinitely. That's as long as the robot dogs don't finish you off first. If they detect even the faintest signal of movement, they'll be on you like a tonne of bricks.

Looking back, I can't quite believe how we let this happen. There had always been oppression, of course, but nothing on this scale. Only when there were signs of serious social unrest did the government decide to act. And when they did, they didn't take any half measures. The emergency services arrived first and told us there'd been a toxic gas leak, which was extremely dangerous. We were supposed to stay indoors and all the blocks of flats would be sealed for our safety.

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The next thing we knew, the 'Metanet' was down and we couldn't get in touch with anyone. Only later did we find out that the same thing had been happening in towns and cities up and down the country. By the time we realised something was wrong, the emergency services had vanished, to be replaced by the robot dogs.

Having had no contact with the outside world, I didn't find out about The Resistance for months. The first thing I knew about it was through a hand-written note which appeared under my door. Having destroyed it, I don't remember the exact wording, but it said something about joining The Resistance to fight for justice. Admittedly, I didn't know how I could help, but no one needed to persuade me to join up. Since the robot dogs are the only thing stopping us leading a normal life, I'd be more than happy to eliminate them. Truth be told, though, success is far from guaranteed. They're connected to a nationwide network of surveillance cameras and sensors through the Metanet. Only by bringing down the Metanet can we deactivate the dogs, and the only way of doing that is by getting into one of the servers and inserting a virus.

Yet even if all goes to plan, we'll need to rebuild a world without the Metanet. Before all this happened, we were promised that it was our key to a golden future. It was supposed to connect man and machine, revolutionising our lives in the process. It would use the power of our imaginations to achieve extraordinary things. The reality, of course, is that its centralised brain has been turned against us and now we're all locked up in our own homes. The way I see it, there's no alternative now but for us to destroy the Metanet and turn back the clock to a time when technology can't become more powerful than humans.

7 Read the extract again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 What does the narrator say in the first paragraph?
- **A** The house feels exactly like a house she used to live in.
- **B** The situation reminds her of something she has seen in the past.
- **C** The sky is the most perfect thing she has ever seen.
- **D** The reason she left the house was to talk to her neighbours.

2 What does the narrator suggest in the second paragraph?
- **A** She has never been out of the tower block before.
- **B** She would risk going outside in order to go to the park.
- **C** She knew she had been dreaming when she woke up.
- **D** She was annoyed with herself for hitting her head.

3 What does the narrator imply in the third paragraph?
- **A** She had seen previous signs of serious social unrest.
- **B** She had expected the emergency services to vanish.
- **C** She is doubtful about the claim of a hazardous event.
- **D** She already knew about similar events in other places.

4 How does the narrator feel about The Resistance?
- **A** delighted to help them in destroying the robot dogs
- **B** afraid of what will happen if they do not succeed
- **C** annoyed about the hand-written note they sent her
- **D** convinced they can insert the virus into the server

5 What does the narrator say about the Metanet in the final paragraph?
- **A** It was successful in revolutionising people's lives.
- **B** It was intended to improve people's imaginations.
- **C** It was manipulated to imprison people against their will.
- **D** It was never meant to be more powerful than people.

/10

Total: /50

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Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures. Ask: To what extent will these jobs change in the future?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people wearing different types of clothes. Why might the clothes they are wearing be important in these situations?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

WRITING

4 Match 1–5 with a–e to complete the sentences from blog posts and opinion essays.

1 Some people just can't be ___
2 Let's not forget that people didn't ___
3 Solutions must be found to ___
4 So what's wrong with ___
5 Elections often require the ___

a always have the right to vote.
b voting for a party that won't get in?
c help of large numbers of volunteers.
d bothered to vote in elections.
e eliminate the problem of voter fraud.

/5

5 Read the essay question below and write your response.

'The rich are getting richer and the poor are getting poorer.'

To what extent do you agree with this opinion?

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /40

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